

English

Grade 10

Unit 2

Cultural festivals of Pakistan Unity in Diversity

Answer the following questions

1. **Why is jashn-e-baharan celebration often referred to as the kite festival and what did it celebrate?**

Ans **Jashn-e-Baharan (Kite Festival):**

Jashn-e-Baharan is often called the Kite Festival because people fly kites of various colours and shapes during the event. It celebrates the beginning of the spring season in the Punjab region. The festival is marked with great enthusiasm and energy. It includes cultural activities like flower exhibitions, musical concerts, traditional dances, and stalls of traditional food. It reflects the vibrant spirit of the season and Pakistan's rich cultural heritage.

2. **What customary events take place at shandur polo festival, and where it is held?**

Ans: **Shandur Polo Festival:**

The Shandur Polo Festival is held at the Shandur Pass in the Chitral district of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, at an altitude of 3,734 meters. Customary events include a traditional polo match between the teams of Chitral and Gilgit. It also features traditional dance performances, music, and food. People from all over the world attend this high-altitude cultural event.

3. **Importance of Kalash festival and how it relates to The identity of Kalash people?**

Ans :**Kalash Festival:**

The Kalash Festival is a three-day vibrant cultural event held in the Kalash Valley of Chitral. It is important as it symbolizes the preservation of Kalash identity amid changing times. The festival involves colourful rituals, traditional dances, music, and agricultural cycles. It reflects the Kalash community's ancient customs, beliefs,

and spiritual connections. It strengthens their unique ethnic identity and passes traditions from one generation to another.

4. What is the role of Sibi Mela in Balochistan culture and economic landscape?

Ans: Role of Sibi Mela:

Sibi Mela is a prominent annual festival in Balochistan celebrated in February. It serves as a platform to showcase the rich cultural heritage of the region through traditional dances, folk music, and vibrant performances. Economically, it functions as a bustling marketplace for livestock and handicrafts. It fosters community bonds, preserves cultural identity, and contributes to the socio-economic fabric of Balochistan.

5. Describe the cultural significance of nowruz in Balochistan hunza ,chitral and gilgit ?

Ans: Cultural Significance of Nowruz:

Nowruz is a socio-religious festival celebrated on 21st March in Balochistan, Hunza, Chitral, and Gilgit. In Balochistan, it lasts for weeks with main features like distributing coloured eggs. It marks the Persian New Year and celebrates the arrival of spring. In these regions, it highlights shared cultural ties with Central Asia and Iran while showcasing local traditions, fostering family and community unity.

6. What event are usually scheduled on Sindhi cultural day and why it is celebrated by Sindhis?

Ans: Sindhi Cultural Day:

On Sindhi Cultural Day (first Sunday of December), events include literary (poetic) gatherings, musical concerts, seminars, and rallies. People wear traditional Ajrak and Sindhi Topi, exchange gifts, and sing Sindhi songs. It is celebrated to highlight the centuries-old rich culture of Sindh, promote peaceful identity, and strengthen community bonds among Sindhis at home and in the diaspora.

7. How does the lok virsa Mela add to the celebration of Pakistan rich cultural diversity ?

Ans : Lok Virsa Mela:

Lok Virsa Mela is held in Islamabad and celebrates Pakistan's diverse culture and traditions. It showcases the rich heritage of all provinces through gorgeous pavilions displaying handicrafts, cultural dresses, jewellery, pottery, and indigenous food. It provides a platform for artists and performers. This national event promotes cultural diversity and becomes a source of national pride.

- 8. How do the celebrations reflect the unique identities of different regions and what can we infer about the role of such festival in promoting National Unity while preserving cultural heritage ?**

Ans Reflection of Regional Identities & National Unity:

These festivals reflect unique regional identities through local customs, dresses, music, dances, and traditions (e.g., kite flying in Punjab, polo in Chitral, Kalash rituals). They preserve cultural heritage while bringing people together. Such festivals promote national unity by providing platforms for cultural exchange and fostering a sense of shared Pakistani identity. They show that diversity strengthens the nation.

SLO-Based Questions with Answers

Unit-02: Cultural Festivals of Pakistan

- 1. Define the term “Jashn-e-Baharan”. Why is it popularly known as the Kite Festival?**

Jashn-e-Baharan is a spring festival celebrated in Punjab, especially in Islamabad. It is popularly known as the Kite Festival because people fly colourful kites of various shapes during the event. It marks the beginning of the spring season with great enthusiasm and energy. The festival includes flower exhibitions, musical concerts, cultural dances, and traditional food stalls.

- 2. Name the festival held at the highest polo ground in the world and mention its location.**

Shandur Polo Festival is held at the highest polo ground in the world. It is held at Shandur Pass in Chitral district of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province at an altitude of 3,734 meters above sea level.

- 3. List any four cultural festivals of Pakistan mentioned in the unit along with their provinces/regions.**

Jashn-e-Baharan — Punjab/Islamabad

Shandur Polo Festival — Chitral, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Kalash Festival — Kalash Valley, Chitral

Sibi Mela — Balochistan

Sindhi Cultural Day — Sindh

Lok Virsa Mela — Islamabad

4. What is Nowruz? When and where is it celebrated in Pakistan?

Nowruz is a socio-religious festival marking the Persian New Year and the arrival of spring. It is celebrated on 21st March in Balochistan, Hunza, Chitral, and Gilgit. In Balochistan it lasts for weeks. Main features include distributing coloured eggs to friends and family.

5. Explain the importance of the Kalash Festival for the Kalash people and how it helps preserve their identity.

The Kalash Festival is a three-day vibrant cultural event held in Kalash Valley, Chitral. It is very important as it symbolizes the preservation of Kalash identity amid changing times. The festival involves colourful rituals, traditional dances, music, and agricultural celebrations. It reflects the Kalash community's ancient customs, beliefs, and spiritual connections. It passes traditions from one generation to another and strengthens their unique ethnic identity.

6. Describe the role of Sibi Mela in the cultural and economic life of Balochistan.

Sibi Mela is a prominent annual festival celebrated in February in Balochistan. Culturally, it showcases the rich heritage through traditional dances, folk music, and vibrant performances. Economically, it serves as a bustling marketplace for livestock, handicrafts, and local products. It fosters community bonds and contributes to the socio-economic development of the region.

7. What is the significance of Sindhi Cultural Day? Mention any three main activities held on this day.

Sindhi Cultural Day is celebrated on the first Sunday of December to highlight the rich culture and peaceful identity of Sindh. Main activities include:

Wearing traditional Ajrak and Sindhi Topi

Literary gatherings, musical concerts, and seminars

Rallies and exchange of gifts among people.

It strengthens bonds among Sindhis at home and in the diaspora.

8. How does Lok Virsa Mela help in showcasing Pakistan's cultural diversity?

Lok Virsa Mela is held in Islamabad and organized by the National Institute of Folk and Traditional Heritage. It showcases the rich culture of all provinces through beautiful pavilions displaying handicrafts, traditional dresses, jewellery, pottery, and indigenous food. Artists and performers from across Pakistan participate. It has become a source of national pride and promotes cultural diversity.

9. Imagine you are a tour guide. Write a short paragraph promoting Shandur Polo Festival to foreign tourists.

Come and experience the thrilling Shandur Polo Festival, held at the highest polo ground in the world at Shandur Pass, Chitral (3,734m). Watch exciting traditional polo matches between Chitral and Gilgit teams. Enjoy breathtaking mountain views, colourful traditional dances, music, and local food. This festival beautifully blends adventure, culture, and nature. It is a must-visit for those who want to experience Pakistan's unique mountain culture.

10. If you had to organize a cultural festival in your area, which festival from the unit would you take inspiration from and why?

I would take inspiration from Lok Virsa Mela. It brings together cultures from all provinces under one roof. It showcases handicrafts, dresses, music, and food of different regions. This helps people understand and appreciate Pakistan's diversity. It promotes unity while preserving heritage. Such a festival would strengthen cultural bonds in my area.

11. How do the different cultural festivals reflect the unique identities of various regions of Pakistan? Give examples of at least three festivals.

Festivals reflect regional identities through their customs and traditions. Jashn-e-Baharan in Punjab shows vibrant spring spirit through kite flying and flower shows. Shandur Polo Festival in Chitral highlights the adventurous and sports-loving culture of mountain people. Kalash Festival reflects the unique ancient culture, rituals, and identity of the Kalash ethnic group. Sindhi Cultural Day celebrates Sindh's rich literary and traditional heritage.

12. "Festivals promote national unity while preserving cultural heritage." Do you agree with this statement? Explain with reference to any two festivals from the chapter.

Yes, I agree. Lok Virsa Mela brings people from all provinces to Islamabad and showcases their cultures together, promoting national unity. At the same time, it preserves heritage by displaying traditional dresses, crafts, and arts. Shandur Polo Festival preserves the traditional polo game and local culture of Chitral and Gilgit while attracting people from across Pakistan and the world, strengthening national bonds.

13. Why are cultural festivals important for a diverse country like Pakistan? Give your opinion in 5-6 lines.

Cultural festivals are very important for a diverse country like Pakistan. They preserve the unique traditions, languages, and customs of different regions. They provide opportunities for people to learn about other cultures and develop respect for them. Festivals like Lok Virsa Mela and Shandur Polo bring people together and promote national unity. They also boost tourism and the local economy. Overall, they strengthen the “Unity in Diversity” spirit of Pakistan.

14. Which festival from this unit do you like the most and why? How does it contribute to Pakistan’s cultural richness?

I like Jashn-e-Baharan (Kite Festival) the most. It is full of colours, joy, and energy. It celebrates the arrival of spring and brings families and communities together. It contributes to Pakistan’s cultural richness by showcasing music, dances, traditional food, and art. It attracts tourists and reflects the lively spirit of Punjabi culture.

Exercise

Punctuation Marks: Uses and Examples

Punctuation marks are symbols used in writing to make the meaning clear, indicate pauses, and show the tone of the sentence.

1. Full Stop (.)

Use: Ends a declarative sentence (statement).

Examples:

Pakistan is a country rich in culture.

The Shandur Polo Festival is held in Chitral.

2. Question Mark (?)

Use: Ends a direct question.

Examples:

Why is Jashn-e-Baharan called the Kite Festival?

Where is the Kalash Festival held?

3. Exclamation Mark (!)

Use: Shows strong emotion, excitement, surprise, or emphasis.

Examples:

What a beautiful festival!

Hurry up! The kite festival has started.

4. Comma (,)

Use: Shows a short pause, separates items in a list, or separates clauses.

Examples:

The festival includes music, dances, and traditional food.

Jashn-e-Baharan, also known as the Kite Festival, celebrates spring.

5. Semicolon (;)

Use: Joins two closely related independent sentences.

Example:

Lok Virsa Mela is held in Islamabad; it showcases Pakistan's cultural diversity.

6. Colon :

Use: Introduces a list, explanation, or quotation.

Examples:

The festival features many activities: polo matches, dances, and music.

Sibi Mela serves two purposes: cultural showcase and economic activity.

7. Apostrophe (')

Use: Shows possession or contraction.

Examples:

Pakistan's cultural heritage is very rich. (possession)

It's a vibrant festival. (It is)

8. Quotation Marks (" ") / Inverted Commas

Use: Used for direct speech, titles, or special words.

Examples:

He said, "I love the Kalash Festival."

The festival is called "Kite Festival".

9. Hyphen (-)

Use: Joins words to make compound words.

Examples:

Socio-economic development

Three-day festival

10. Dash (—)

Use: Shows a sudden break or adds extra information.

Example:

Lok Virsa Mela — a national cultural event — promotes unity.

Q: rewrite the passage with punctuation

Pakistan is a land of diverse cultures and rich traditions. Every region of the country celebrates its unique festivals with great enthusiasm. Jashn-e-Baharan, popularly known as the Kite Festival, marks the arrival of spring in Punjab. People fly colourful kites, enjoy music and traditional food. Similarly, the Shandur Polo Festival is held at the highest polo ground in the world in Chitral. It features exciting polo matches, traditional dances and music. These festivals not only preserve our cultural heritage but also promote national unity. They reflect the beautiful principle of "Unity in Diversity" in Pakistan.

Punctuation

Pakistan is a land of diverse cultures and rich traditions. Every region of the country celebrates its unique festivals with great enthusiasm. Jashn-e-Baharan, popularly known as the Kite Festival, marks the arrival of spring in Punjab. People fly colourful kites, enjoy music and traditional food. Similarly, the Shandur Polo Festival is held at the highest polo ground in the world in Chitral. It features exciting polo matches, traditional dances and music. These festivals not only preserve our cultural heritage but also promote national unity. They reflect the beautiful principle of "Unity in Diversity" in Pakistan.